The Ultimate “Cheat Code” for Writing Better AI Prompts

You open an AI tool, type “make me a cool game,” and wait for something amazing. Instead, you get a game that barely resembles what you imagined. The character is wrong, the rules are confusing, and the background looks completely different.

The problem may be the gap between what you pictured and what you actually described. AI cannot see the idea in your head. A useful prompt gives it enough information to work toward that idea.

The closest thing to an ultimate prompting “cheat code” is this: **describe what success looks like, then revise based on what you get.** You do not need complicated vocabulary or a secret phrase. You need a clear goal, useful details, and a willingness to experiment.

Start With the Result You Want

Before typing, finish this sentence: “By the end, I want…”

Maybe you want a thirty-second animation about a lost robot, a beginner-friendly explanation of fractions, or a game where a player catches falling stars. Naming the result helps you move beyond vague requests such as “make something fun.”

Compare these two prompts:

“Give me a game idea.”

“Suggest three game ideas for middle school students that can be played using only the arrow keys. Each game should have one clear objective and take less than two minutes to play.”

The second prompt gives the AI concrete requirements. It also makes the response easier to judge: you can check whether each idea meets them.

Give Details That Change the Answer

A longer prompt is not automatically better. The most useful details are the ones that influence the result.

For an animation, those might include the characters, setting, action, mood, and length. For an explanation, they might include the audience’s age, what they already understand, and where they are confused. For a game, they might include the controls, objective, and difficulty.

Try this simple structure:

Goal + context + requirements + format

For example:

“Write a short introduction for an AI Explorers animation showcase. The audience includes middle school students and their parents. Use a friendly, excited tone, mention animation, games, and music, and keep it under 100 words.”

Each detail has a purpose. You do not need to add a dramatic role such as “You are the greatest writer in history” when a direct description will do.

Show What You Mean

Words such as “creative,” “professional,” and “exciting” can mean different things to different people. An example can make your preference clearer.

Instead of asking for “an exciting opening,” you could say:

“Start with a surprising event, such as a robot discovering that its shadow has disappeared.”

You can also describe what to avoid: “Keep the humor playful, with no jokes that embarrass another character.” Clear boundaries help define the project.

When using someone else’s work as a reference, identify the qualities you appreciate—such as a mysterious mood or short, lively dialogue—and ask for an original result with those qualities.

Revise One Thing at a Time

Your first response gives you something to evaluate. Read, watch, or test it before deciding what comes next.

Avoid feedback such as “make it better.” Explain what needs to change:

“Keep the story, but shorten the opening.”

“Make the instructions easier for a fifth grader to follow.”

“Keep the character’s appearance consistent across all three scenes.”

Changing one major feature at a time makes it easier to understand which instruction helped. Save prompts that work, along with a note about why they worked.

Keep Your Judgment Switched On

A detailed prompt can still produce incorrect information or an unusable result. Check facts, test instructions, and inspect generated work carefully. For school assignments, follow your teacher’s rules and make sure the work reflects your own understanding.

The best prompt writers pay attention. They notice what is missing, explain what they want, and make thoughtful adjustments. Start with a small project, try a clear prompt, and compare the output with your goal. Each revision teaches you something you can use the next time you open the tool.